



MAKERERE UNIVERSITY

POLICY ON PERSONS LIVING WITH DISABILITIES

SEPTEMBER 2022

1.0 PURPOSE

The aim of this policy is to support the University's provision of a physical, working, learning and social environment that enables and enhances the educational and employment experience of students and staff living with disabilities on the same basis as other members of the University community. This is because the University promotes an environment that values diversity, is free from harassment, unlawful discrimination and promotes equal opportunities.

2.0 POLICY STATEMENT

Makerere University is committed to developing and supporting an inclusive and diverse environment which provides equal opportunity for all staff and students to access, participate and enjoy the benefits of education and employment. The University therefore is committed to respect, promote and protect the rights of persons living with disabilities to work and study on an equitable basis with other members of the University community.

The University, its staff and students shall comply with the provisions of the persons with Disabilities Act 2020 and other relevant National and International legislation.

Harassment, discrimination and vilification of persons with disabilities shall not be tolerated and all University members will work together in compliance with the Equal Opportunities policy, 2006.

The University is committed to ensuring the integration of the principles of equal access, equal participation and equal opportunity for persons living with disabilities in all relevant University policies, procedures and operations.

In its planning procedures, the University embraces the principle of Universal inclusion and design, i.e. embedding in the design of the environment, services, work, curricula

development, study design and content, the capacity to provide access to a diverse range of users, including persons living with disabilities.

The University also seeks to apply the principle of reasonable adjustment to remove barriers to participation in work or study by persons living with disabilities, and to caretakers of persons living with disabilities, including parents, spouses, partners and those with caring responsibilities for persons with a disability.

The University will support and foster positive, informed behaviour and attitudes among its staff and students towards persons living with disabilities and will assist staff in developing and offer disability-friendly skills and services to meet the learning and support needs of students and staff living with disabilities.

The University will progressively provide resources and facilities for appropriately accessible and supportive learning and working environments, including assistive technologies and other reasonable adjustments for persons living with disabilities and, whenever reasonably possible, will provide access to any service generally provided by the University to staff and students.

The University will ensure that the academic integrity of programs offered is maintained at the highest standards and will ensure students living with disabilities are provided with appropriate and reasonable adjustments to enable access and participation in all educational activities including access to written material on the same basis as other students.

3.0 DEFINITIONS

- a. **Assistive technology** - is any device, system or design, whether adapted or commercially available, that allows someone to perform a task that they would otherwise be unable to do, or increases the ease with which a task can be performed.
- b. **Associates** - includes people who are a partner, carer, friend, and family member, business/sporting associate or work colleague.

- c. **An Academic Integration Plan (AIP)** is a document established by students with disabilities with their Disability Advisor outlining the 'reasonable adjustments or academic strategies that support them to complete their academic work while managing their symptoms.
- d. **Carer or Care giver** means a person who provides personal care, support and assistance to another person because of their disability and age-related needs. This excludes care, support or assistance provided as part of paid or unpaid work, a service provision contract, and/or education or training program. A person is not inherently considered a carer solely on the basis of their family and/or domestic relationship to the person in need of care.
- e. **Disability** is defined as a permanent and substantial functional limitation of daily life activities caused any physical or sensory impairment and environmental barriers resulting in limited participations (National Policy on Disability in Uganda 2006). The policy focuses on the following disabilities;
 - i. Difficulty in hearing;
 - ii. Difficulty in speaking and conveying messages;
 - iii. Difficulty in moving around and using other body parts;
 - iv. Difficulty in seeing;
 - v. Strange behavior;
 - vi. Epilepsy;
 - vii. Difficulty in learning;
 - viii. Leprosy;
 - ix. Loss of feeling
 - x. Multiple disabilities (A combination of any of the above disabilities)
- f. **Flexible work arrangements** means arrangements in which the supervisor and staff member jointly decide on friendly work arrangements for example changes to hours of study or work, location, and/or the way work is carried out.
- g. **Harassment** on the grounds of disability includes s intimidation, insults or humiliation of any person(s) living with disability.

- h. **Indirect discrimination** on the grounds of disability occurs when a person with a disability is expected to meet criteria, rules or policy that apply to all persons, but that have an unfair effect on people with disabilities. For example, making the only entrance to premises by stairs, which means the premises are inaccessible to people with mobility disability, or the provision of information in forms that are inaccessible to people with a print disability.
- i. **Inherent requirements** are the core activities, tasks or skills that are essential to a workplace in general, and to a specific position. They are a major part of the job, and result in significant consequences if they are not performed. Inherent are also special components of a program or subject that demonstrate the abilities, knowledge and skills to achieve the core learning outcomes of the program or subject.
- j. **On the same basis** - means that a person with a disability is able to seek admission, employment, participate in University programs, and use University facilities and services equally like any other member of staff of the University or student.
- k. **Reasonable adjustments** means administrative, environmental and or procedural alterations in the employment or learning situation which remove barriers for people with a disability so that they can perform the inherent requirements of the job or program of study.
- l. **Reasonable Adjustment Plan (RAP)** means the University plan to set up or to cater for the needs of the persons with disabilities using the facilities or accessing the services of the University.
- m. **Universal design** means a design of products, communications and built environments, to be usable by as many people as possible at a minimum or no extra cost without the need for adaptation to or specialized design. A universal design approach to curricula is student-centered, inclusive and enables students with a disability to demonstrate equivalence in learning outcomes.
- n. **Unjustifiable hardship** means an exception that allows an organization to reject making an adjustment because the cost involved and the impact on the organization and/or other persons would be very high vis-à-vis the University's financial

situation. In determining whether an adjustment would involve unjustifiable hardship, all relevant circumstances of the situation must be taken into account.

o. **Unlawful discrimination** – means;

- i. Treating or proposing to treat a person with a disability less favorably than a person without any disability in circumstances that are the same or not materially different. For the avoidance of doubt, the circumstances shall not be considered materially different due to the fact that different accommodation or services may be required by the person with a disability;
 - ii. unreasonably requiring a person with a disability to comply with a requirement or condition which he or she is unable to comply with due to his or her disability in the circumstances; or
 - iii. Treating a person with a disability less favorably because he or she is accompanied by or is in the possession and or using of a palliative or therapeutic device or an auxiliary aid, or an interpreter, assistant, carer or an assistance animal (e.g. a guide or hearing dog).
- p. **Victimization** means threatening to use or use of less favorable treatment of a person with a disability for his or her participation in making, supporting the resolution and or resolving a complaint, whether that participation was actual, intended or presumed.

4.0 PROCEDURES

- a. This Policy should be implemented in conjunction with the 1995 Constitution of the Republic of Uganda (as amended), the Persons with Disability Act 2020 and the national Equal Opportunity Policy 2006. The above legislative and policy provisions make it unlawful for any Person to discriminate against any Person, in the provision of educational, employment, services and facilities on the basis of disability. Students and prospective students living with a disability must be able to access and participate in education on the same basis as other students.

- b. The University shall protect the access to confidential information relating to students and staff with disabilities in its possession. Access to such information will be restricted to staff with a legitimate need to access such information in the execution of the mandate of the University. Such members of staff may include Staff designated as Disability Service staff, and Welfare staff, direct supervisors or managers, Program Coordinators, Examinations Officers or Deans.

Access to the Medical and diagnostic specifics of the nature of the disability or condition of a person living with disability shall not be accessed by a supervisor or teaching staff except for legitimate reasons; and in such circumstances such information may be accessed only with the written consent of the person with the disability or health condition.

- c. A member of Staff and or a Student is not required to disclose his or her disability unless:
 - i. An Academic Integration Plan (for students) or a Reasonable Adjustment Plan (for staff) is required to be developed and implemented;
 - ii. The disability or chronic health condition is likely to affect the staff or student's capacity to meet the inherent requirements of the job or the subject or program.
- d. In order to assist in the planning, provision of services and timing of implementation of adjustments Plans, prospective or current students and staff with disabilities are encouraged to identify any alternative requirements as soon as practicable. Failure to declare specific requirements at the earliest opportunity may lead to a disruption of a student's study program, or a delay in service provision or of a staff member's induction/return to the workplace and/or their capacity to maintain reasonable productivity at work. Such disruption or delay shall not be attributed to the University.

- e. Reasonable adjustments are available to staff and students living with disabilities and will be developed and implemented to enable:
 - i. a staff member with a disability to undertake the inherent requirements the position; or
 - ii. A student with a disability to access and participate in academic studies and to meet the academic standards and inherent requirements of the program.

4.1 Reasonable Adjustment Plans for Staff

1. The process for staff to formalise their adjustment requirements is by way of adherence to the Reasonable Adjustment Plan (RAP). For staff this could mean adjusting access to buildings and rooms, modifying equipment, re-designing jobs or work areas and implementing more flexible work practices. For students it could mean adjustments to the mode of delivery of lectures or written material or the assessment process and timeframe. An adjustment is reasonable if it takes into account the requirements of the person and balances the interests of all parties affected. Consideration needs to be given to:

- a. the effect of the adjustment on the person's ability to meet the inherent requirements of the job or successfully achieve the inherent learning outcomes of the subject or program;
- b. the costs and benefits of making the adjustment; and

The interests of all parties affected, including those of the student or staff member with the disability, the University, staff and other students or colleagues.

The University is committed to ensuring that the workplace provides reasonable adjustments to meet the specific requirements of staff with a disability through the provision of adjustments, including:

- a. flexible work arrangements;
- b. modifications to work premises;
- c. changes to job design, working hours and schedules or other work practices;
- d. modifications to equipment;
- e. Provision of training or other assistance.

2. The requirement to provide adjustments for staff with a disability applies to all areas of employment, including:

- a. recruitment, selection and appointment;
- b. training and career development;
- c. study and conference leave;
- d. performance management; and
- e. Promotion, transfer or any other benefit.

3. Adjustments may be permanent or temporary, depending on the nature of the disability or condition and the requirements of the individual. The degree and nature of the disability may also change over time and require regular review of additional or alternative adjustments. Reasonable adjustments in the workplace may be required when a person has:

- a. a pre-existing or established condition of or disability;
- b. an acquired condition of or disability, whether temporary or permanent; or
- c. A non-work-related injury or illness, which may be temporary or permanent.

In instances where an injury results in an ongoing disability, a Reasonable Adjustment Plan may be appropriate to support such a staff member in the workplace following the completion of a Return to Work Plan. Injury Management Coordinators will refer the affected staff to the Equity, Diversity and Wellbeing in these situations and facilitate the transition in supporting the staff concerned.

- c. In case the University determines that an adjustment would cause it unjustifiable hardship, it shall take in to account:
 - i. the benefits or disadvantages that would be caused by making the reasonable adjustment;
 - ii. the effect of the disability on the student or staff member;
- iii. The costs of making the reasonable adjustment in the context of the University's financial situation.

4.2 Staff Requesting and Initiating a Reasonable Adjustment Plan

- a. A request for reasonable adjustment in the workplace may be made by a member of staff (or a potential member of staff) or their supervisor, with the consent of the staff member concerned. Disclosure of a disability can be made to the Directorate of Human Resources or the staff member's supervisor.
- b. A Member of Staff and a prospective member of staff with a disability, or carers, are encouraged to seek advice and assistance from the Directorate of Human Resources on concerns of or information relating to Reasonable Adjustment Plans. Members of Staff are responsible for assisting supervisors and any Member or staff or concerned person requesting an adjustment to determine the most appropriate reasonable adjustments in the workplace.
- c. New members of staff are encouraged to complete the staff Equal Opportunity Survey form in the Directorate of Human Resources and indicate if they have a disability for which they require an adjustment. The University Management will be advised of a member of staff's request if the person indicates on the Equal Opportunity Survey that they have a disability for which they require an adjustment. Disability Support Center staff will then contact the staff member to offer assistance in developing appropriate and reasonable adjustments. Existing staff who acquire a temporary or permanent disability are also encouraged to review their entry on the Equal Opportunity Survey database at the time they seek adjustment, to ensure that effective measurement and resourcing of disability services to staff can be maintained.
- d. A member of staff who requires an adjustment because of an existing disability should request such reasonable adjustment as early as possible in the employment process. Opportunities for enquiring about and/or requesting adjustments may most commonly arise:
 - i. during the selection/interview process;
 - ii. at orientation or induction processes;
 - iii. when planning for organizational change;
 - iv. in developing Workload Agreements; or

- v. At any stage of the performance management cycle.
- e. A member of staff who has disclosed a disability may, with his or her consent, also be referred by other members of staff. Including a Supervisor and Personnel from the Directorate of Human Resources.
- f. Opportunities for new members of staff to formally disclose a disability should be made available after an employment contract has been finalised, including during induction processes. Disability staff are available to assist staff and students in making disclosure decisions. The Disability Service will also assist students with disclosure decisions and may work with the Disability Centre to meet the needs of members of staff who are also students of the University.

4.3 Documentation for Staff

- a. Members of Staff who seek reasonable adjustments in the workplace shall provide current (no more than 6 months old) documentation of assessments of such disability from a recognised medical or other recognised professional specialist, to confirm their disability/health condition with arecommendations on the most appropriate type of workplace adjustments.
- b. Medical documentation is required to:
 - i. support the assessment of reasonableness of the request for adjustments in the circumstances; and
 - ii. Ensure that only ergonomically/medically appropriate adjustments are provided.
- c. Documentation in support of a Reasonable Adjustment Plan may be required more or less frequently, depending on the nature of the disabilities/conditions affecting the staff and their impact in the workplace. Medical documentation must remain up-to-date and relevant to the current requirements of the member of staff's position at the workplace.
- d. Staff with a temporary, degenerative and/or episodic condition shall provide documentation more frequently, whereas staff with a permanent and stable disability which is unlikely to change over time shall be required to provide

documentation at longer intervals. This will be determined at the discretion of the Senior Staff Disability Advisor.

- e. The documentation will include information on the disability and the functional limitations it involves and, as far as possible, provide recommendations on the appropriate type of workplace adjustments which are required to support the disability.
- f. Reasonable adjustments may include flexible work practices and reduced hours of work if appropriate.
- g. Medical documentation relating to a member of staff's disability shall only be submitted to the Directorate of Human Resources, and information provided to supervisors shall relate solely to the appropriate adjustments required in the workplace.
- h. Medical documents provided by the member of staff for the purpose of a Reasonable Adjustment Plan shall not be placed on the files of People and files of the staff member with a disability (unless requested in writing by the member of staff with the adjustment), but shall be kept on file in the Directorate of Human Resources.
- i. The University may, upon recommendation of the Director, University Hospital, refer the member of staff to a medical practitioner, psychologist or other relevant health professional of its choosing for assessment of the staff member's disability and for a recommendation of relevant adjustments required in the workplace. Any medical assessments of this nature shall be intended only for the purpose of determining the need for, nature of, and possibility of making any required reasonable adjustment.
- j. Where it is recommended that a member of staff works from home for a period of time, as a component of a Reasonable Adjustment Plan, the member of staff with the disability will complete a Working from Home Checklist Agreement, to be retained on file by the Directorate of Human Resources as an appendix to the Reasonable Adjustment Plan.
- k. A member of staff shall provide the Medical documentation to the Directorate of Human Resource at the time of the formal request for adjustment being made, or the

development of a formal Reasonable Adjustment Plan shall lapse. A Reasonable Adjustment Plan Request Form can be downloaded via the Directorate of Human Resource webpage.

- i. The University may require more detailed advice from medical specialists to refine the adjustments required. A Reasonable Adjustment Plan shall not be developed without supporting medical evidence.

4.4 Action on Staff Adjustments

- a. Upon receiving a request from a member of staff for the provision of an adjustment Plan(s), the member of staff's supervisor shall make every reasonable effort to act on the request in a timely manner. Actions taken by a supervisor may include:
 - i. seeking advice from the Directorate of Human Resource and or referring the member of staff for advice;
 - ii. requesting information about staff entitlements or relevant policies from the Office of the Directorate of Human Resource;
 - iii. ensuring that arrangements are made available for required adjustments, often in consultation with their School or Unit/Division managers;
 - iv. Ensuring that relevant administrative staff make the necessary arrangements for the implementation of the required adjustments, e.g. timetabling or staffing changes.
- b. Upon receipt of a request for the development of a Reasonable Adjustment Plan, the Staff Disability Advisor will consult with the member of staff on the following matters as may be deemed relevant:
 - i. the nature, severity and duration of the disability, injury or illness;
 - ii. the functional limitations placed on the staff member by the disability or condition;
 - iii. whether the disability or condition is likely to change over time and the most relevant and appropriate review timeframe;

- iv. what specific adjustments, if any, have been suggested or can be identified by the staff member; and
 - v. Whether further specialist evaluation is required to identify and implement appropriate adjustments.
- c. The development of a Reasonable Adjustment Plan shall be prioritised on a needs basis, as determined by the Senior Staff Disability Advisor.
- d. The Senior Staff Disability Advisor shall open a confidential Reasonable Adjustment file to record the information outlined above. The Reasonable Adjustment file, including the completed Plan, will be kept on file in separate from the member of staff's personnel records which are held within the Office of the Directorate of Human Resources. The Reasonable Adjustment file will only, except with the written consent of the member of staff, be accessible to the member of staff and the relevant Disability Support Center staff members.
- e. If further evaluation is required, information may be sought from other sources, as appropriate and in consultation with the staff member, from;
 - i. a specialist medical practitioner;
 - ii. an occupational therapist or other allied health provider;
 - iii. a disability service provider;
- f. The adjustment required will be determined on the basis of the particular needs of the staff member. The Senior Staff Disability Advisor will consider the preferences and views of the staff member, in conjunction with medical advice, in negotiating and determining the most appropriate and efficient approach to making reasonable adjustments.
- g. Any claim of unjustifiable hardship made by a member of staff responsible for implementing adjustments will be referred to the Directorate of Human Resource.

4.5 Administration of Staff Adjustments

- a. Once an assessment has been made, the implementation of the adjustments will be discussed at a meeting convened by staff from the Directorate of Human Resources, involving the supervisor and the staff member. The supervisor, as the 'Responsible

Officer', will be responsible for the day-to-day implementation of the adjustment in the workplace. Every effort will be made to implement adjustments in a timely, effective and efficient manner.

- b. The supervisor responsible for signing the Reasonable Adjustment Plan and implementing adjustments shall be the affected member of staff's immediate supervisor where possible. This University delegated officer (the 'Responsible Officer') should have sufficient seniority to ensure that the required adjustments are implemented with the greatest possible efficiency and confidentiality.
- c. Where alterations are required to buildings or facilities, the relevant School or Division will negotiate with the Office of Estate and Works to carry out the alterations. A record of alterations or plans in progress should be forwarded to the Directorate of Human Resource.
- d. A University Reasonable Adjustment Plan shall be deemed finalised when a copy of the Reasonable Adjustment Plan record, signed by both the member of staff and the responsible supervisor (on behalf of the University) has been received by the Directorate of Human Resources. All parties are required to participate in the timely and effective completion of adjustment arrangements.
- e. Where a concern is raised about the reasonableness of an adjustment which cannot be resolved by the Senior Staff Disability Advisor in the context of facilitating the Reasonable Adjustment Plan, the matter will be referred to the Directorate of Human Resource. A final decision on whether adjustment is reasonable will be made by the Vice-Chancellor.

4.6 Costs of Staff Adjustments

- a. The costs of making reasonable adjustments shall be the obligation for the University. Wherever practicable, the Senior Staff Disability Advisor will seek to access funding for adjustments through available external funding sources. Otherwise, the costs of implementing workplace adjustment (e.g., further medical or work health assessment, provision of assistive equipment, individual workplace modifications or flexibility in ways of working) will be funded by the Directorate of Human Resources.

- b. Adjustments involving alterations to buildings, grounds or facilities will be conducted by Directorate of Estates and Works subject to availability of funds.
- c. The cost of Personal aids or equipment that are required by the member of staff for private, non-work related purposes will not be funded by the University.

4.7 Monitoring Staff Reasonable Adjustment Plans

- a. Reasonable Adjustment Plans shall be reviewed on a needs basis, as maybe agreed by the member of Staff and the Supervisor (on behalf of the University), in consultation with the Senior Staff Disability Advisor.
- b. Where the circumstances of a member of staff with a disability change in relation to their health, working arrangements, allocated supervisor, office location, and/or other relevant considerations, he or she and the or her supervisor shall advise the University Disability Centre team.
- c. The Director Human Resources, shall be responsible for evaluating, monitoring and reporting on the Staff Workplace Adjustment Program, associated funding, and consulting with relevant persons on any recommended changes.
- d. Resource documents and further information on the provision of workplace adjustments for staff and carers of persons with disabilities shall be provided by Directorate of Human Resources.

4.8 Reasonable Adjustments for Students

4.8.1 Selection, Admission and Enrolment of Students

- a. Applicants, for Study at the University, with a disability will be admitted as students to the Makerere University subject to meeting the academic entry requirements which apply to all students enrolling in the same program at the relevant time. Students with a disability will also be able to apply for admission under the range of Special Admission Schemes available within the University. Such Schemes provide an opportunity to students to be considered for admission by the University where the student's disability has disadvantaged him or her in meeting the relevant academic requirements for a particular programme.

- b. To be approved for admission under these Schemes, the student has to have the academic and functional ability to complete the chosen program of study and meet the inherent requirements of the program, subject to the provision of any reasonable adjustments and support services required to eliminate barriers to access and inclusion.
- c. Makerere University offers all students an orientation program. This program includes information on available support services and policies relating to persons living with disabilities. Information on services to assist students with disabilities will be publicised on the University web site.

4.8.2 Support for Students with a Disability

- a. As part of academic support services, the University offers a range of specialised services and programs to students with disabilities. These include pre-enrolment advice and assistance with enrolment; orientation; academic note-taking services; personal readers; carers/ helpers and Sign Language interpreters; relocation of lectures where necessary for access and liaison with teaching staff in relation to reasonable adjustments and provision of assistive devices to enhance academic integration.
- b. The Disability Advisor is the nominated contact person responsible for ensuring that a student with a disability is provided with appropriate support and services. Students with disabilities are strongly encouraged to make contact with the Disability Service prior to enrolment or before the commencement of semester. This will provide sufficient time for the University to identify the students' requirements and for the Disability Advisor to organise and implement appropriate reasonable adjustments.
- c. Students are required, at the time of registering with the Disability Service, to submit relevant documentation of assessment from an accredited health or educational professional. The documentation is to include information of the nature of the disability and recommendations on the type of adjustments required. Recommendations will be considered but may not be implemented as

- recommended. Documentation is not acceptable if it's more than two years old. Students may be requested to periodically provide documentation on re-assessment.
- d. In the event that appropriate documentation is not available at the time of registering, the Disability Advisor may accept an interim medical certificate or educational report. The interim certificate/report will be valid for University documentation for a maximum period of four-weeks from the date of registration.
 - e. An individual plan, to be designated as the Academic Integration Plan, will be developed for each student with a disability or chronic health condition registered with the Disability Service. The Academic Integration Plan will not disclose the nature of the student's disability or chronic health condition. The Academic Integration Plan will set out the specific reasonable adjustments required by the individual student. The University will, within a reasonable time frame, implement the Academic Integration Plan. Academic Integration Plans will be reviewed periodically.
 - f. Students are required to give written approval for the Academic Integration Plan to be distributed to lecturers and relevant staff for implementation. Students are required to sign an Academic Integration Plan Distribution Consent form prior to an Academic Integration Plan being distributed.
 - g. Makerere University will appoint Unit Disability Coordinators across the University. The unit Disability Coordinator will be a contact point for the Disability Advisors, students with disabilities and teaching staff within each Unit/School. The School/Unit Disability Coordinator will be a resource to other academics on implementation of adjustments set out in the Academic Integration Plan in relation to teaching and assessment. School/Unit Disability Coordinator will assist with the organisation of individual student examination arrangements and appropriate methods of assessment. School Disability Coordinator will meet regularly with Disability Service staff.

4.8.3 Curriculum Development, Accreditation and Delivery

- a. Before a subject is approved by the University Senate, the inherent requirements of the subject must be identified and included in the subject handout. It must be

demonstrated that reasonable requirements of students with disabilities, in relation to curriculum, field work, laboratory work, practicum, teaching practices and assessment, have been taken into consideration in the program design. Wherever possible, inclusive teaching and assessment practices will be incorporated into curricula, program delivery and assessment.

4.8.4 Reasonable Adjustments in Teaching and Assessment

- a. Makerere University will develop guidelines for the adjustments to be provided in relation to teaching practices and assessment. Examples of appropriate adjustments include lectures that make use of formats and approaches suitable for students with vision or hearing impairments; individual exam conditions such as scribes, extra time or enlarged print papers; alternative forms of assessment such as oral exams; appropriate adjustments to field work, laboratory work and practicum according to the nature of the disability.
- b. Wherever possible and appropriate, the Disability Service will provide registered students with program material in an accessible alternative format. A student may be required to purchase an electronic version of a text book rather than print copy.
- c. Where appropriate, a student with a disability or chronic health condition may be approved to have a Note taker, Reader, Practical Assistant, or Sign Language interpreter who must follow specific instructions provided by the Disability Service.
- d. While students are required to meet subject/program assessment requirements as determined by the University, provision will be made for reasonable variations in assessment in order to meet the requirements of the student with a disability.

Any student with a disability who may require reasonable adjustments in a subject are requested to seek advice and assistance at the commencement of the term, or soon thereafter, from the Disability Advisor or School Disability Coordinator.

- e. Students with disabilities will be permitted to use aids or assistance appropriate to their disability or chronic health condition during examinations. Examination adjustments will be stipulated in the Academic Integration Plan. Notification of

exam adjustments will be provided by the Disability Service not less than thirty working days prior to the commencement of the main exam period.

- f. Students with a disability or chronic health condition will be permitted to use aids appropriate to suit their disability during lectures, tutorials, assessments, examinations and or during work experience or educational practicum/placements.

4.8.5 Action on Adjustments - Academic Integration Plan Procedures

- a. More detailed information on the Disability Service guidelines, policies and procedures in relation to the provision of reasonable adjustments for students with disabilities will be available at the Disability support Centre.
- b. The Disability Service, in conjunction with a student with a disability or chronic health condition, will undertake a comprehensive assessment at the time of registration. The assessment will be in line with the Persons with Disability Act 2020 and the National Equal opportunity policy 2006.
- c. This assessment will form the basis of the Academic Integration Plan. The plan will set out the academic, practicum, examination, library, security and information technology requirements the student will need whilst studying at Makerere University. Where appropriate, a student undertaking a professional placement may require the development of an additional Placement Integration Plan that includes adjustments specific to the placement/work experience.
- d. The Academic Integration Plan will be sufficiently flexible to enable modification or additional adjustments to be incorporated into the plan to reflect changes in circumstances or health status. Students will negotiate any changes to the Academic Integration Plan with the Disability Service.

The distribution and implementation of the Academic Integration Plan to relevant academic staff is the responsibility of the Head of Department. The Academic Integration Plan is to be implemented by the relevant Academic offices within five (5) working days of the Academic Integration Plan being sent electronically to the Subject Coordinator.

- e. An electronic copy of the Academic Integration Plan will be sent to the student's University email account within two working days of the Academic Integration Plan being finalised. Students should discuss the plan with the Subject or Practicum Coordinator, lecturer, School Disability Coordinator and/or tutor in a timely period after receiving their Academic Integration Plan.

4.8.6 Academic Integration Plans (AIP) Procedures

Academic Integration Plans will be issued to Heads of Department by the Disability office not less than ten working days prior to the commencement of the semester. New or amended Academic Integration Plans developed after this period will be issued within two working days. Heads of Department are responsible for ensuring all the adjustments stipulated in the Academic Integration Plan are implemented by the lecturers teaching in the nominated subjects within five working days of receiving the Academic Integration Plan. Practicum/Placement Coordinators are responsible for ensuring the appropriate adjustments are implemented in the teaching/work environment.

4.8.7 Academic Assistance

- a. The Course Coordinator is responsible for reviewing, the provisions and ensuring the implementation of the academic 'reasonable adjustments' included in the Academic Integration Plan.
- b. The school/college Disability Coordinator is to liaise directly with College/ School Course Coordinators concerning any recommendations that may have significant impact on the teaching or assessment of the subject. Where implementation of the reasonable adjustments set out in the Academic Integration Plan is withheld, the Heads of Department must notify the Disability Advisor in writing within five working days from date of receipt of the Academic Integration Plan indicating rationale for the decision.
- c. If necessary, the School Disability Coordinator will convene a meeting between the Head of Department, the Disability Advisor and/or the student, within five working days of notification of non-approval of the plan, to resolve the difficulties.

- d. If there is no objection to the Academic Integration Plan, it is to be distributed to relevant lecturers and implemented within five working days from the date of receipt.
- e. The Academic Integration Plan will state the reasonable adjustments required by the student for in-class tests and formal end-of-Semester examinations. The College Principals will be responsible for ensuring that all coordinated examinations, including deferred examinations requirements, are implemented for students registered with the College/ School.
- f. The School Disability Coordinator and the School/College Registrar are responsible for assisting academic staff with the implementation of examination provisions for students with a disability for all non-coordinated examinations (exams occurring outside of the official coordinated Examination period).
- g. Where appropriate, School Disability Coordinators will assist staff in the development of individual examination arrangements and alternative methods of assessments (e.g., oral examinations/presentations) to accommodate students with particular disabilities (e.g., hearing or hand/arm impairment). The Disability Service Centre will provide and fund, where appropriate, a scribe, reader or practical assistant. Specialised equipment required will be supplied by the Disability Service.
- h. The implementation of this policy is the responsibility of all staff and students of the University.
- i. All staff shall undertake to provide equity for students and other staff with disabilities and perform their duties in a non-discriminatory manner.
- j. Members of Staff:
 - i. are expected to undertake development activities and staff development training to gain knowledge, skills and awareness of disability issues and the requirements of students and staff with a disability;
 - ii. Who are Managers and Academic Supervisors will ensure that persons living with a disability are not discriminated against or harassed in the workplace and in the college/ School. This includes ensuring that there are no attitudinal or other barriers which result in less favorable treatment of persons with disabilities;

- iii. will assist in the implementation of Academic Integration Plans and Reasonable Adjustment Plans to provide equal access in all areas of employment, teaching and learning;
- iv. will implement all the reasonable adjustments stipulated in the Academic Integration Plan and the Reasonable Adjustment Plan for staff and students who have a disability;
- v. are responsible for creating a climate in which students and other staff are encouraged to discuss issues arising from the impact of the disability on their studies or work;
- vi. must have due regard for each person's right to privacy and confidentiality when seeking information for the purpose of making reasonable adjustments;
- vii. With a disability will determine whether they declare their disability and will liaise appropriately with their supervisor to establish the most effective implementation of adjustments and the degree of assistance or adjustment which is required.

k. Student's Responsibilities:

- i. Prospective or enrolled students with a disability are required to familiarize themselves with the inherent requirements of their chosen program before enrolment.
 - ii. Prospective students and/or enrolled students are to familiarize themselves with the eligibility criteria for registration with professional registration boards before enrolling in the program.
- l. In order to obtain specific adjustments, it is necessary that people with a disability declare the nature of their disability in a timely manner and provide medical evidence to staff of the Disability Support Centre.
- i. Students with a disability have the right to not declare their disability. Implementation of reasonable adjustments to the educational program is only possible if the student declares their identity, the nature of their disability to the Disability Advisor, Disability Service Centre.

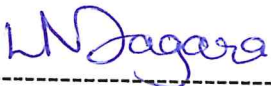
- m. Students with a disability who are enrolled in a program where practicums are an essential component may be requested to undertake, at no cost, an additional assessment to ensure the student is able to meet the inherent requirements of the practicum.
- n. Makerere University is committed to ensuring that all University buildings and facilities are accessible to students, staff and the wider community. The University will achieve this through an ongoing program of review and improvements to the physical access of existing buildings and facilities and ensuring that new buildings are accessible and compliant with the most current version of the Access to Premises Standards and be consistent with the requirements of the Person's with Disability Act 2020.
- o. Makerere University's Libraries and Information Technology Centres will make available resources in accessible format, services and professional assistance to support the information and research requirements of students and staff. The University's Libraries and Information Technology Centres will assist students and staff with a disability to ensure equitable access to information and technology services, including assistive technologies.
- p. The University will progressively ensure that all new website content complies with Disability Act.
- q. Persons living with disability will be encouraged to apply for positions at the University. All recruitment and selection processes will be inclusive of the requirements of persons living with disabilities. This includes processes such as advertising, job design, interviewing and medical assessments. Interview processes will be adjusted where the candidate has made a relevant disclosure within a reasonable period of the interview.
- r. Persons living with disabilities will have the same terms and conditions by which employment is offered to persons without disabilities.
- s. Members of Staff with disabilities will have equal opportunities for promotion and career development. The University will provide appropriate assistance for members of staff with a disabilities to attend University approved work activities such as staff training, study and conference leave.

4.8.8 Work, Health and Safety.

4.8.8.1: Budget

- a. The University will, as part of its cyclic budget process, determine an appropriate allocation of funding to resource disability support services to students and staff. The funding will be allocated as a budget to the areas responsible for administering disability policy and it will be the responsibility of those areas to develop a detailed budget plan and to report on expenditure of funding against that budget plan, income performance, output and appropriate performance measures. In determining the annual allocation, the University needs to take into account the requirement that funding should be available for the provision of physical access, and reasonable workplace and teaching and learning accommodations and other support requirements of students and staff with disabilities.
- b. Staff and students who believe they have been treated unfairly on the grounds of disability are encouraged to use the University procedures on appeals, grievances and complaints. Makerere University is committed to accessible, fair and confidential processes for the resolution of complaints based on allegations of discrimination on the grounds of disability.
- c. Any questions or concerns on matters pertaining to disability discrimination may be referred to the Disability service centre

Approved this.....^{28TH}..... day of ...^{September}..... 202~~1~~



Lorna Magara (Mrs.)

CHAIRPERSON UNIVERSITY COUNCIL



Yusuf Kiranda

SECRETARY TO COUNCIL